

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

 **ATTACK REPORT**

European Firms Hit by Sophisticated Cloud Phishing Campaign

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Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2024467

Summary

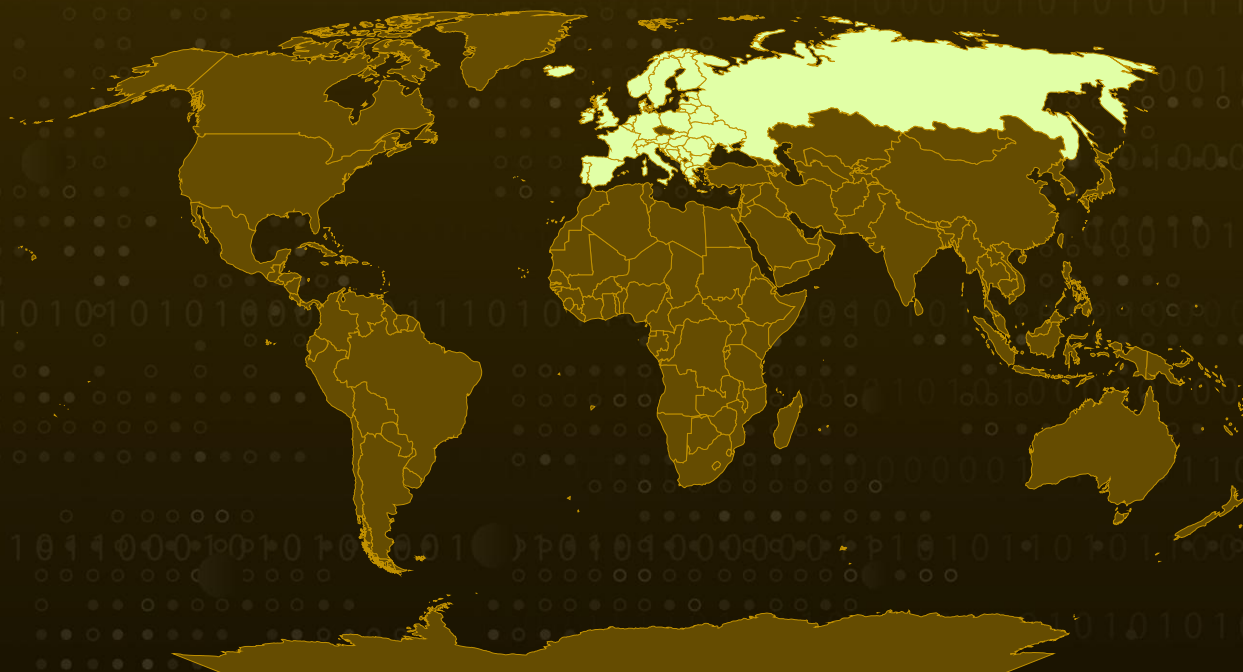
Attack Discovered: June 2024

Targeted Countries: Europe

Affected Industries: Automotive, Chemical, Industrial compound manufacturing

Attack: A sophisticated phishing campaign has been observed targeting European organizations, particularly in Germany and the UK, with the goal of harvesting account credentials and compromising victims' Microsoft Azure cloud environments. The campaign reached its peak in June 2024, leveraging fraudulent forms crafted using the HubSpot Free Form Builder service. This operation demonstrates a calculated approach by the threat actors, who successfully targeted approximately 20,000 users across multiple European companies.

Attack Regions



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Attack Details

#1

A sophisticated phishing campaign is discovered, targeting European companies, particularly in Germany and the UK, with the aim of stealing account credentials and compromising Microsoft Azure cloud infrastructures. Beginning in June 2024, the campaign impacted approximately 20,000 users across industries such as automotive, chemical manufacturing, and industrial compound production. As of September 2024, the operation remains active, highlighting its persistent threat to enterprise security.

#2

The attackers employed deceptive emails containing DocuSign-enabled PDF attachments or embedded HTML links. These links redirected victims to fraudulent pages crafted using HubSpot Free Form Builder services. Although HubSpot itself was not compromised, its platform was exploited to create convincing phishing forms. The malicious attachments often featured filenames incorporating the victim organization's name, and clicking on them led to fake Microsoft Outlook Web App login pages designed to harvest credentials.

#3

The phishing infrastructure leveraged at least 17 active HubSpot Free Forms that redirected victims to attacker-controlled domains hosted primarily on the .buzz top-level domain. The attackers owned and operated their hosting environments, granting them full control and anonymity to conduct multiple phishing operations. To bypass detection, they employed VPN proxies to mimic login attempts from trusted geographic locations matching the victim organizations.

#4

Once the attackers gained access, they strengthened their foothold by registering new devices to victims' accounts, ensuring continued access even as IT teams worked to remediate the situation. In some cases, this resulted in prolonged struggles between attackers and defenders, with the attackers initiating password resets to hinder recovery efforts. These tactics delayed mitigation and overwhelmed security teams with additional alerts.

#5

This phishing campaign demonstrates the attackers' ability to combine technical precision with social engineering, leveraging trusted platforms to exploit their victims. Organizations are advised to strengthen defenses. The evolving nature of such attacks underscores the need for a proactive and multi-layered approach to enterprise cybersecurity.

Recommendations



Enhanced Email Security: Enhance email security by Implementing advanced spam filters, anti-phishing solutions, and email authentication protocols. Educate employees about identifying and reporting suspicious emails to prevent successful phishing attempts.



Remain Vigilant: It is essential to remain cautious. Be wary of clicking on suspicious links or visiting untrusted websites, as they may contain malicious content. Exercise caution when opening emails or messages from unknown sources, as they could be part of phishing attempts.



Implement Behavioral Analysis: Deploy advanced security solutions that employ behavioral analysis and anomaly detection to identify unusual patterns of activity indicative of malware presence. This proactive approach can help catch sophisticated threats before they fully compromise your systems.



Enable Account Activity Logging: Ensure detailed logs are maintained for all account creation events, capturing metadata like the creator's identity, IP address, location, and timestamp. Regularly review these logs for anomalies.



Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0042</u> Resource Development	<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>T1078</u> Valid Accounts
<u>T1078.002</u> Domain Accounts	<u>T1586</u> Compromise Accounts	<u>T1090</u> Proxy	<u>T1068</u> Exploitation for Privilege Escalation
<u>T1134</u> Access Token Manipulation	<u>T1102</u> Web Service	<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1566.001</u> Spearphishing Attachment
<u>T1566.002</u> Spearphishing Link	<u>T1136</u> Create Account	<u>T1204</u> User Execution	<u>T1204.001</u> Malicious Link
<u>T1036</u> Masquerading	<u>T1665</u> Hide Infrastructure		

✂ Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
URLs	hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1P_6IFHnbRriC_DG56YzVhw2dz72l, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1UgPJ18suRU-NEpmYkEwteg2ec0io, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/12-j0Y4sfQh-4pEV6VKVOeg2dzmbq, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1cJXJ0NfTPOKwn23oAmmzQ2e901x, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1wg25r1Z-R5GkhY6k-xGzOg2dvcv5, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1G- NQN9DbSVmDy1HDeovJCQ2ebgc6, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1AEc2-gS4TuyQyAiMQfB5Qw2e5xq0, hxxp[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1wg25r1Z-R5GkhY6k-xGzOg2dvcv5, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1zP2KsosARaGzLqdj2Umk6Q2ekgty, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1fnJ8gX6kR_aa5HlRyJhuGw2ec8i2, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1QPAfZcocSuu3AnqznjU14A2eabj0, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/176T8k3N9Q562OEEfhS22Fg2ebzvj, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/18wO3Zb9hTluittmhHvQFuQ2ec8gt, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1vNr8tB1GS4mZuYg81ji3dg2e08a3, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1qe8ypRpdTr284rkNpgmoow2ebzty, hxxps[:]//share-eu1[.]hsforms[.]com/1C1IZ0_b-SD6YXS66alL4EA2e90m9, hxxps[:]//technicaldevelopment[.]industrialization[.]buzz/?o0B=RLNT, hxxps[:]//vigaspino[.]com/2doc5/index[.]php?submissionGuid=1d51a08d-cf55-4146-8b5b-22caa765ac85, hxxps[:]//technicaldevelopment[.]rljaccommodationstrust[.]buzz/?WKg=2Ljv8, hxxps[:]//purchaseorder[.]vermeernigeria[.]buzz/?cKg=C3&submissionGuid=4631b0c9-5e10-4d81-b1d6-4d01045907e7, hxxps[:]//asdrfghjk3wr4e5yr6uyjhgb[.]mhp-hotels[.]buzz/?Nhv3zM=xl7Kyf, hxxps[:]//purchaseorder[.]europeanfreightleaders[.]buzz/?Mt=zqoE&submissionGuid=476f32d0-e667-4a18-830b-f57a2b401fc3, hxxps[:]//orderspecification[.]tekfenconstruction[.]buzz/?6BI=AmaPH&submissionGuid=e2ce33ea-ee47-4829-882c-592217dea521, hxxps[:]//asdrfghjk3wr4e5yr6uyjhgb[.]mhp-hotels[.]buzz/?Nhv3zM=xl7Kyf, hxxps[:]//d2715zbmeirdja[.]cloudfront[.]net/?__hstc=251652889[.]fcaff35c15872a69c6757196acd79173[.]1727206111338[.]1727206111338[.]1727206111338[.]1&__hssc=251652889[.]158[.]1727206111338&__hsfp=1134454612&submissionGuid=30359eaf-a821-472d-ba17-dd2bd0d96b96, hxxps[:]//docusharepoint[.]fundament-advisory[.]buzz/?3aGw=NI9, hxxps[:]//wr43wer3ee[.]cyptech[.]com[.]au/oeeo4/ewi9ew/mnph_term=?/ &submissionGuid=50aa078a-fb48-4fec-86df-29f40a680602, hxxp[:]//orderconfirmation[.]dgpropertyconsultants[.]buzz/, hxxps[:]//esperonal[.]org/doc0024/index[.]php?submissionGuid=6e59d483-9dc2-48f8-ad5a-c2d2ec8f4569, hxxps[:]//vigaspino[.]com/2doc5/index[.]php?submissionGuid=093410a5-c228-4ddf-890c-861cdc6fe5d8,

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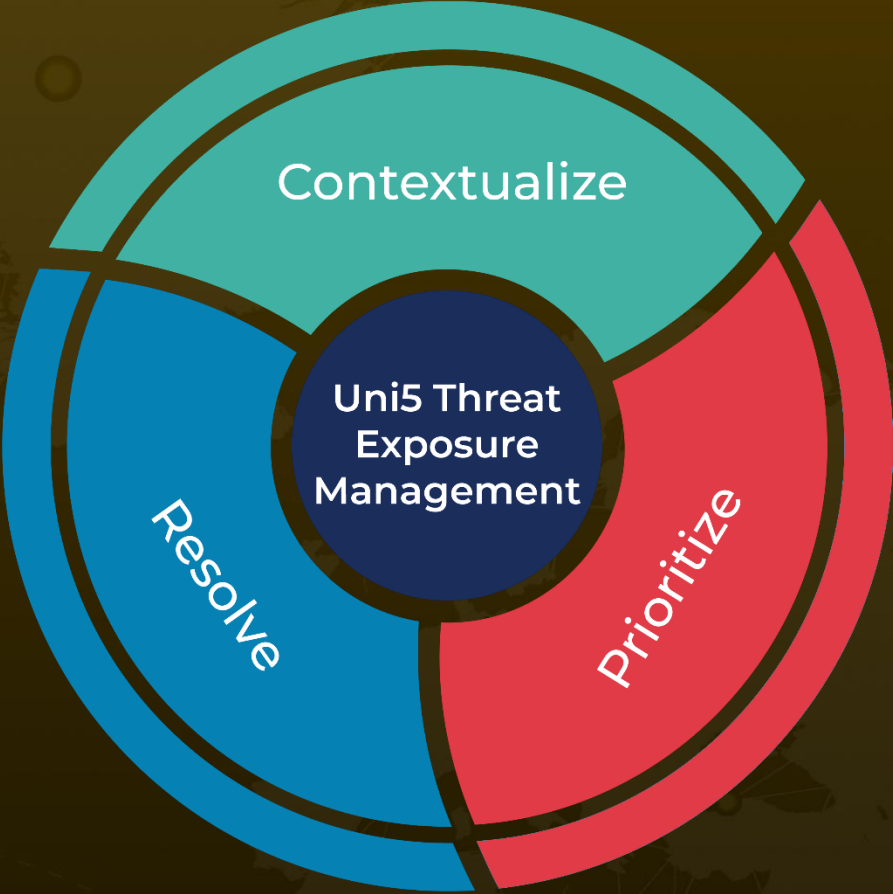
References

<https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/european-phishing-campaign/>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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